

Sierra Leone

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** April 27, 1961 **Usage:** National and Civil



Africa



Sierra Leone was founded as a home for freed slaves in 1787, but became a British colony in 1808. It achieved independence in 1961.

The arms and flag of Sierra Leone were devised by the College of Arms and granted in 1960.

ARMS OF SIERRA LEONE

The shield depicts a lion beneath a zigzag border, representing the Lion Mountains after which the territory was named, and three torches. At the

base are wavy bars depicting the sea. The supporters are lions, similar to those on the colonial badge.

The three main colors from the shield—green, white and blue—were used to form the flag. They represent agricultural and natural resources in green, unity and justice in white, and blue for the harbor at Freetown.

ARMS OF SIERRA LEONE

